Present continuous

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Talk about actions happening now (lo que está pasando ahora)
- Form the present continuous with am, is, are + -ing
- Spell the -ing form correctly
- Ask «What are you doing?» and describe a picture

Para pensar

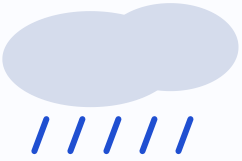
Tu madre te llama por teléfono y te pregunta «What are you doing?». ¿Qué te está preguntando y cómo le contestarías?

Explicación

Actions happening now

We use the present continuous for actions that are happening **now**, at this moment: «Look! It's **raining**», «Shh! The baby is **sleeping**», «I'm **reading** a great book».

It's different from the present simple, which is for habits: «I **read** every night» (costumbre) / «I'm **reading** now» (ahora). **En castellano:** es igual que «estoy leyendo», «está lloviendo». La terminación **-ing** equivale a nuestro **-ando** o **-iendo**: reading = leyendo, playing = jugando.



Look! It's raining.

now = ahora mismo

How to make it: be + -ing

The present continuous has **two parts**: the verb to be (am, is, are) + the main verb with -ing. «I **am** play**ing**», «She **is** eat**ing**», «They **are** runn**ing**».

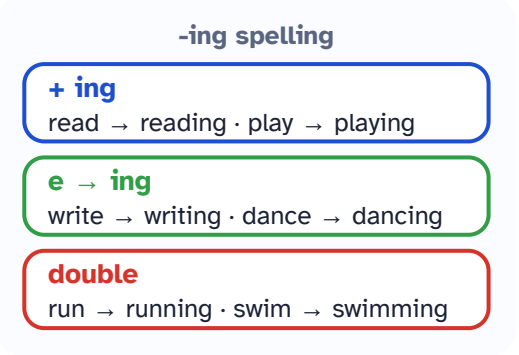
We use **am** with I; **is** with he, she, it; and **are** with you, we, they. In conversation we use short forms: I'**m**, she'**s**, they'**re**. **En castellano:** *to be* hace el papel de «estar»: «I'm eating» = «estoy comiendo».

Person	be	-ing
I	am ('m)	playing
he/she/it	is ('s)	playing
you/we/they	are ('re)	playing

Spelling the -ing form

Most verbs just add **-ing**: read → read**ing**, play → play**ing**, cook → cook**ing**. Verbs ending in **-e** lose the e: write → writ**ing**, dance → danc**ing**, make → mak**ing**.

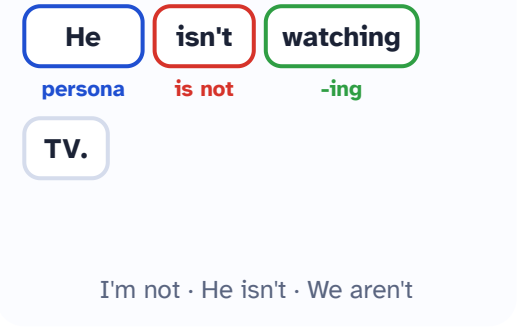
Short verbs with **consonant + vowel + consonant** double the last letter: run → ru**nn**ing, swim → swi**mm**ing, sit → si**tt**ing, get → ge**tt**ing. **Truco:** si la palabra es corta y termina en consonante-vocal-consonante, ¡dobla la última letra!



Negative: I'm not...

To make a negative, put **not** after am, is or are: «I'**m not** sleeping», «He **isn't** watching TV» (is not), «We **aren't** playing» (are not).

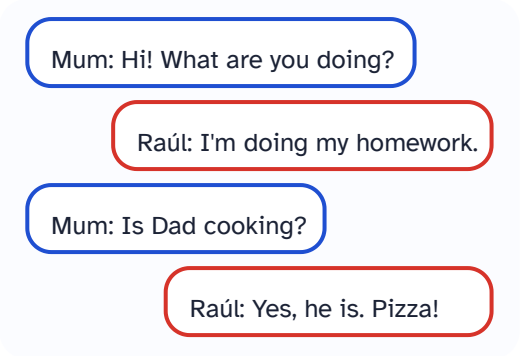
It's very useful to correct someone: «I'm not sleeping, I'm thinking!», «She isn't crying, she's laughing!». **En castellano:** «no estoy durmiendo» → «I'm not sleeping». Fíjate en que con *I* no existe la forma «amn't»: decimos siempre **I'm not**.



Questions: What are you doing?

For questions, put **am, is, are** first: «**Are** you listening?», «**Is** she sleeping?». Short answers: «Yes, I **am**. / No, I'**m not**.», «Yes, she **is**. / No, she **isn't**.»

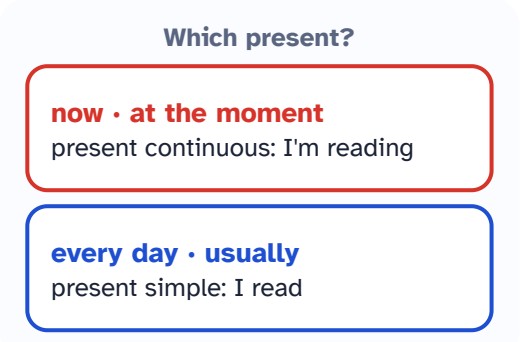
The most famous question is *What are you doing?* (¿Qué estás haciendo?). Also: «**Where are** you **going**?», «**Who is** she **talking** to?». **En castellano:** aquí no necesitamos *do*: el verbo *to be* ya hace de ayudante.



Time words: now, at the moment, look!

The present continuous often comes with *now*, *right now*, *at the moment* (en este momento) and *today*: «We're having lunch **at the moment**», «She's working at home **today**».

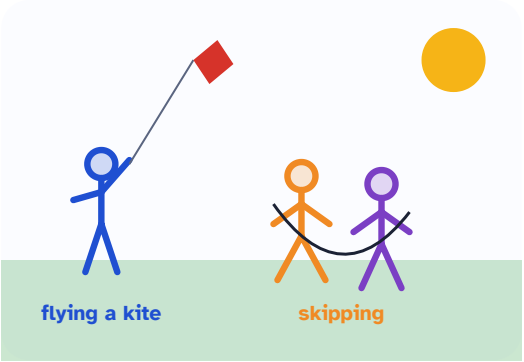
Also, when we want someone to see something, we say **Look!** or **Listen!**: «**Look!** The cat is climbing the tree!», «**Listen!** Someone is singing». Compare with the present simple time words: **every day**, **usually**, **on Mondays**. **Pista:** si ves *now*, piensa en *-ing*.



Describing a picture

The present continuous is perfect to **describe a picture** or a photo. Look at the park: «A boy **is flying** a kite. Two girls **are skipping** (saltando a la comba). A man **is walking** his dog. A baby **is sleeping** in a pram. The sun **is shining**».

Start with **In the picture** or **I can see**: «In the picture, I can see a family. They are having a picnic». **Consejo:** usa *is* con una persona y *are* con dos o más.



Reading: a postcard from the beach

Read Paula's postcard: «Dear Grandma, I'm writing from the beach in Menorca! It's sunny and hot. Right now Mum **is reading** a book under the umbrella and Dad **is swimming**. My little brother **is building** a sandcastle. He **isn't wearing** his hat, oops! I'm **eating** a delicious ice cream. Some children **are playing** volleyball near us. We're **having** a great time! Love, Paula.»

Answer: What is Dad doing? Is her brother wearing his hat? What is Paula eating?



Let's practise: mime and guess

Play **Mime and guess** (mímica). One student picks a card with an action and mimes it in front of the class: brushing teeth, playing the piano, riding a horse, eating spaghetti... The class asks: «**Are you swimming?**» – «No, I'm not!» – «**Are you dancing?**» – «Yes, I am!».

Then the class says the full sentence: «**She's dancing!**». **Consejo:** fíjate en si preguntas a la persona («Are you...?») o hablas de ella al resto de la clase

(«She's... / He's...»).



Present continuous

I	he · she · it	you · we · they	question
AM + ING	**IS + ING**	**ARE + ING**	**WHAT...?**
I'm reading. I'm not reading.	She's running. She isn't running.	They're eating. They aren't eating.	What are you doing? Yes, I am.

Ejercicios

1. **Write the -ing form: play, make, sit.**

2. **Complete with am, is or are: «They ___ singing.»**

3. **Complete: «Look! The dog ___ (run).»**

4. **Make it negative: «I'm sleeping.»**

5. **Make it negative: «We are watching TV.»**

6. **Make a question: «You are listening.»**

7. **Short answer (no): «Is your brother studying?»**

8. **Present simple or continuous? «I ___ (read) now.»**

9. **Translate: «¿Qué estás haciendo?»**

10. **Describe what three people in your house are doing now.**

Practica

1. **We use the present continuous for...**
   - **A)** habits
   - **B)** the past
   - **C)** actions happening now
2. **«I ___ reading.»**
   - **A)** am
   - **B)** is
   - **C)** are
3. **«They ___ playing.»**
   - **A)** is
   - **B)** are
   - **C)** am
4. **The -ing form of «swim» is...**
   - **A)** swiming
   - **B)** swimming
   - **C)** swimmng
5. **The -ing form of «write» is...**
   - **A)** writeing
   - **B)** writting
   - **C)** writing
6. **«He ___ watching TV.» (negativa)**
   - **A)** isn't
   - **B)** doesn't
   - **C)** aren't
7. **«___ you listening?»**
   - **A)** Do
   - **B)** Is
   - **C)** Are
8. **«What are you doing?» means...**
   - **A)** ¿Qué haces cada día?

B) ¿Qué estás haciendo?

C) ¿Qué hiciste?

9. **Which sentence is present continuous?**

A) She's dancing.

B) She dances.

C) She danced.

10. **Which word goes with the present continuous?**

A) at the moment

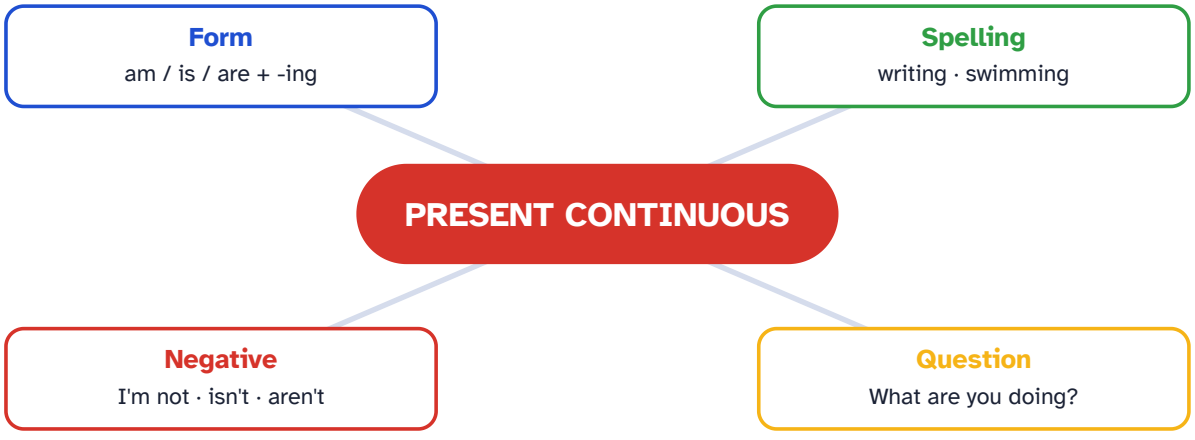
B) every day

C) usually

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Para qué sirve el presente continuo; Cómo se forma con am, is, are y -ing; Las reglas de ortografía de -ing; Cómo se hacen negativas y preguntas, y en qué se diferencia del presente simple.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

present continuous

Lo que está pasando ahora.

I'm playing

Estoy jugando.

She's eating

Ella está comiendo.

-ing

-ando / -iendo.

swimming

Doble consonante: swim → swimming.

He isn't...

Negativa: no está...

What are you doing?

¿Qué estás haciendo?

at the moment

En este momento.

Soluciones

1. **C)** Ahora.
2. **A)** I + am.
3. **B)** They + are.
4. **B)** Doble m.
5. **C)** Se quita la e.
6. **A)** is not.
7. **C)** you + are.
8. **B)** Ahora mismo.
9. **A)** is + -ing.
10. **A)** En este momento.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. playing, making, sitting.
2. are.
3. is running.
4. I'm not sleeping.
5. We aren't watching TV.
6. Are you listening?
7. No, he isn't.
8. I'm reading (now).
9. What are you doing?
10. Model answer: My mum is working. My dad is cooking. My sister is playing a video game.